

RetailMind · Store Operations & Policy Manual

1. PURPOSE

This manual sets out the standard operating policies for all RetailMind stores. It covers customer returns, supplier relationships, store hours, product handling, and staff responsibilities. All store managers and department leads are required to read and follow these policies.

2. SCOPE

These policies apply to all RetailMind retail locations across all regions. Regional managers may issue supplementary guidance, but may not override any policy in this document without written approval from the Operations Director.

Section 3 · Customer Returns

3. CUSTOMER RETURN POLICY

3.1 Standard return window

Customers may return any unused, undamaged product within 30 days of purchase with a valid receipt. Items returned within this window are eligible for a full refund to the original payment method.

3.2 Extended return window

For purchases made between 1 November and 31 December (holiday season), the return window is extended to 60 days from the date of purchase.

3.3 Non-returnable items

The following categories are non-returnable:

- Perishable food and beverage items once opened
- Personal care products once unsealed
- Digital downloads and software licences

3.4 Damaged or defective goods

Items that are damaged or defective on arrival may be returned or exchanged at any time within 90 days, regardless of whether the standard 30-day window has passed. Proof of defect (photograph or in-store inspection) is required.

3.5 Return without receipt

Returns without a receipt are accepted at the store manager's discretion.

The customer will receive store credit at the current selling price, capped at the maximum 30-day window from the estimated purchase date.

Section 4 · Supplier & Procurement Policy

4. SUPPLIER VETTING AND PROCUREMENT

4.1 Approved supplier list

All products sold in RetailMind stores must be sourced from suppliers on the Approved Supplier List (ASL). The procurement team maintains the ASL and reviews it quarterly. No store may purchase stock from a supplier not on the ASL without prior written approval from the Procurement Director.

4.2 Supplier onboarding

New suppliers must complete a four-step vetting process:

Step 1 · Submit company registration documents and insurance certificates.

Step 2 · Pass a quality audit conducted by RetailMind's QA team or an accredited third-party auditor.

Step 3 · Agree to RetailMind's Supplier Code of Conduct, which includes labour standards, environmental requirements, and anti-bribery provisions.

Step 4 · Complete a trial order of no more than \$5,000 before being granted full ASL status.

4.3 Pricing and contracts

All supplier pricing must be agreed in writing before any order is placed.

Verbal pricing agreements are not binding. Contracts are renewed annually in January unless either party gives 60 days' written notice of termination.

4.4 Preferred supplier incentives

Suppliers who achieve an on-time delivery rate of 95% or above and a defect rate below 0.5% over a rolling 12-month period are designated Preferred Suppliers. Preferred Suppliers are given priority consideration for new product line placements.

Section 5 · Store Operations

5. STORE HOURS AND OPERATIONS

5.1 Standard store hours

All RetailMind stores operate on the following schedule unless a regional supplement specifies otherwise:

Monday to Friday: 08:00 · 20:00

Saturday: 09:00 · 18:00

Sunday: 10:00 · 16:00

5.2 Public holidays

Stores are closed on national public holidays. Stores in regions with local bank holidays must post the closure notice at least 7 days in advance.

5.3 Opening and closing procedures

The store manager or a designated deputy must be present for opening and closing. The opening checklist includes: cash float verification, safety walkthrough, and POS system startup. The closing checklist includes: cash reconciliation, stock count of high-value items, and alarm activation.

5.4 Minimum staffing levels

At no time may a store operate with fewer than two staff members on the floor. If staffing falls below this level, the store manager must contact the regional HR coordinator immediately to arrange cover.

Section 6 · Product Handling

6. PRODUCT HANDLING AND STORAGE

6.1 Receiving stock

All deliveries must be checked against the purchase order at the point of receipt. Discrepancies of more than 2% by quantity or value must be reported to the procurement team within 24 hours. Accepted stock must be logged in the inventory system on the day of receipt.

6.2 Temperature-sensitive products

Coffee, dairy, and fresh produce must be stored at the temperatures specified on the product packaging. Temperature logs must be completed twice daily. Products found outside the safe temperature range must be quarantined and disposed of according to the Waste Disposal Procedure (Appendix B).

6.3 High-value item security

Items with a retail price above .50 must be stored in a locked display case or behind the counter when not being shown to a customer. Inventory counts for high-value items are conducted at the close of every business day.

6.4 Damaged stock

Damaged stock must be removed from the sales floor immediately and logged in the damage register. Damaged items may not be sold at a discount without approval from the store manager. Items with a cost value above .20 must be reported to the regional loss-prevention team before disposal.

6.5 Expiry date management

Staff must check expiry dates during every restocking cycle. Products within 14 days of their expiry date must be moved to the clearance section and marked with a minimum 25% discount. Products past their expiry date must be removed from sale immediately.

Section 7 · Data and Privacy

7. CUSTOMER DATA AND PRIVACY

7.1 Data collected at point of sale

RetailMind collects transaction data (items purchased, price, date, and store location) for every sale. No personally identifiable information is collected at point of sale unless the customer voluntarily provides it for the loyalty programme.

7.2 Loyalty programme data

Customers who join the loyalty programme consent to the collection of their name, email address, and purchase history. This data is used solely for programme administration and personalised offers. It is never sold to third parties.

7.3 Retention periods

Transaction data is retained for 7 years to satisfy tax and audit requirements. Loyalty programme data is retained for as long as the account is active, plus 2 years after the last transaction.

7.4 Data breaches

Any suspected data breach · including unauthorised access to the POS system or loss of a device containing customer data · must be reported to the Data Protection Officer within 24 hours of discovery. The DPO will determine whether regulatory notification is required under applicable law.